

SERVICE LEVEL AGREEMENT

Between NovaBridge Solutions LLC and Meridian Financial Services

Agreement Reference: NBS-SLA-2024-0847

Effective Date: January 15, 2025

Service Credit Remedies: In any calendar month where measured availability falls below the committed SLA target, NovaBridge shall issue service credits as follows: 99.9%-99.5%: 5% of monthly recurring charges; 99.5%-99.0%: 10% of MRC; <99.0%: 20% of MRC. Total service credits in any month shall not exceed 50% of that month's recurring charges (the "Credit Cap").

Article 1: Agreement Overview and Definitions

This document sets forth the complete terms and conditions under which NovaBridge Solutions LLC provides managed hosting and cloud infrastructure services to Meridian Financial Services. The parties acknowledge the critical nature of these systems to global financial operations.

The primary objective is to maintain uninterrupted service delivery, establishing strict operational guidelines, financial remedies, and governance models. By executing this agreement, both entities commit to a framework of continuous improvement.

The governing law for any disputes, interpretations, or enforcement actions shall be the State of New York, excluding its conflict of laws principles. The initial term spans thirty-six (36) months, structured with an auto-renewal mechanism for successive twelve (12) month periods unless formally terminated.

Definitions:

Availability: The percentage of time during a calendar month that the core platform is fully operational and responsive to authorized network requests.

Business Day: Monday through Friday, excluding federal holidays recognized within the United States of America.

Change Window: A pre-approved temporal period specifically reserved for executing authorized system modifications.

Critical Incident: An unplanned event causing complete loss of core functionality across multiple availability zones.

Degraded Operation: A state where systems remain accessible but perform below documented baseline thresholds.

Emergency Change: A rapid deployment authorized to mitigate active security threats or restore catastrophic outages.

Force Majeure: Unforeseeable external circumstances beyond reasonable control, including natural disasters and acts of war.

Scheduled Maintenance: Planned downtime communicated in advance and excluded from penalty calculations.

Service Credit: Financial restitution applied to the customer invoice following verified performance breaches.

Data Sovereignty: The legal principle ensuring customer information remains within specified geographical boundaries.

Failover Event: An automatic or manual transfer of workload processing from a primary system to a standby system triggered by detection of a service-affecting fault condition.

Hot Standby: A redundant system configuration in which the standby components are powered, synchronized, and capable of assuming the primary role within the defined RTO without manual intervention.

Incident Commander: The designated NovaBridge operations engineer who assumes authority for coordinating response activities during a Severity 1 or Severity 2 incident.

Key Performance Indicator: A quantifiable metric agreed upon by both parties to measure the effectiveness and quality of services delivered under this Agreement.

Latency Budget: The maximum allowable round-trip network delay, measured in milliseconds, between the customer demarcation point and the NovaBridge compute tier.

Managed Backup: The automated process of creating, verifying, and retaining point-in-time copies of customer data in accordance with the retention schedule specified in Schedule B.

Network Demarcation: The physical and logical boundary point at which NovaBridge network infrastructure terminates and customer-managed equipment begins.

Operational Readiness Review: A formal assessment conducted prior to production deployment to verify that all infrastructure, monitoring, and runbook requirements have been satisfied.

Peak Usage Period: The recurring time window during which aggregate customer workload demands historically exceed 80 percent of provisioned capacity, typically weekdays 09:00 to 17:00 ET.

Quarantine Zone: An isolated network segment used to contain potentially compromised workloads pending forensic analysis and remediation.

Recovery Validation: The process of confirming that restored data and systems function correctly following a disaster recovery exercise or actual failover event.

Service Catalog: The comprehensive listing of all compute, storage, network, and managed service offerings available to the customer under this Agreement.

Tenant Isolation: The logical and physical separation mechanisms ensuring that one customer's data, network traffic, and processing cannot be accessed by another customer.

Uptime Measurement Window: The calendar month period over which availability percentages are calculated, beginning at 00:00:00 UTC on the first day and ending at 23:59:59 UTC on the last day.

Virtual Private Cloud: A logically isolated network environment within NovaBridge infrastructure providing dedicated IP addressing, routing tables, and security group configurations.

Warm Site: A partially equipped disaster recovery facility that requires additional configuration and data synchronization before assuming production workloads.

Zero-Day Patch: A software update released to address a vulnerability for which no prior fix existed, requiring emergency change procedures as defined in Article 5.

Acceptance Criteria: The predefined set of conditions that must be met before a change, migration, or new service deployment is considered complete and approved for production use.

Bandwidth Allocation: The guaranteed minimum and burstable maximum network throughput provisioned for each customer environment, measured at the network demarcation point.

Compliance Attestation: A formal written statement from an independent auditor confirming NovaBridge adherence to the requirements of a specified regulatory or industry framework.

SLA Exclusions

1. **Force Majeure:** Events beyond the reasonable control of either party, including natural disasters, war, terrorism, pandemic, government action, or widespread infrastructure failures affecting multiple providers simultaneously.
2. **Customer-Caused Outage:** Service disruption directly attributable to the customer's actions, including unauthorized configuration changes, resource exhaustion from runaway processes, or deployment of untested application code.
3. **Scheduled Maintenance:** Pre-announced maintenance activities conducted within the approved Tuesday 02:00 to 06:00 ET window, limited to four hours per calendar month, with notification delivered per Section 5.
4. **DNS Propagation Delays:** Time required for DNS record changes to propagate across global resolvers, which is outside NovaBridge infrastructure and governed by TTL values set by the customer's authoritative nameservers.
5. **Third-Party Circuit Failures:** Outages originating in carrier networks, internet exchange points, or last-mile connectivity not operated by NovaBridge, including customer-procured MPLS or dedicated fiber circuits.
6. **Customer Firewall Rule Conflicts:** Service inaccessibility resulting from overly restrictive or misconfigured firewall rules, security group policies, or access control lists implemented by the customer within their environment.
7. **DDoS Mitigation Activation:** Brief service disruption or increased latency during the initial activation of volumetric or application-layer DDoS scrubbing, typically lasting less than 30 seconds per mitigation event.
8. **Customer Capacity Oversubscription:** Performance degradation caused by the customer consuming resources beyond their contracted allocation without requesting a tier upgrade or burst capacity authorization.
9. **Beta and Preview Services:** Any service designated as beta, preview, early access, or experimental, which is offered without availability guarantees and is excluded from SLA credit calculations.
10. **Government or Regulatory Action:** Service interruption mandated by law enforcement, regulatory agencies, or court orders, including subpoena-related data preservation holds or emergency takedown requests.
11. **Utility Provider Failures:** Power outages exceeding the capacity of NovaBridge's on-site UPS and generator systems, typically requiring a sustained grid failure lasting more than 48 hours at the affected facility.

Article 5: Change Management

Standard changes mandate five business days notice. Normal changes require ten days and full CAB approval. Emergency changes permit immediate execution with subsequent 48-hour post-incident review.

Freeze periods strictly prohibit non-critical deployments during quarter-end weeks (last 5 business days) and annually from December 15 through January 5.

Change Type	Rollback Procedure
OS Patching	Snapshot restoration via hypervisor APIs.
Firewall Rules	Revert to prior validated rule-set configuration.
DB Schema Update	Transaction log replay to pre-deployment state.
Network Routing	BGP advertisement withdrawal and path reset.
Storage Expansion	Volume clone detachment and LUN unmapping.
Auth Integration	Fallback to local LDAP credential provider.
Load Balancer	VIP pool drain and traffic redirection.
Hypervisor Upgrade	Live migration of VMs to legacy cluster nodes.

Article 7: Governance and Reporting

Monthly service reviews ensure tactical alignment, supplemented by quarterly executive business reviews for strategic planning. Required monthly deliverables include uptime analysis, security event summaries, change logs, and capacity forecasts.

Level	Role	Contact	Response Time
Tier 1	NOC Analyst	support@novabridge.com	15 mins
Tier 2	Shift Supervisor	Duty Phone	30 mins
Tier 3	Director of Ops	Escalation Pager	2 hours
Tier 4	VP of Cloud Svcs	Direct Mobile	4 hours

Article 8: Term, Termination, and Transition

The thirty-six month term features automatic renewal unless countermanded by a 90-day written notice. Termination for cause dictates a 30-day cure window. Early termination incurs a fee equal to 0.35x remaining contract value.

Post-termination, transition assistance continues for 90 days, culminating in NIST 800-88 certified media sanitization within 30 days of contract end.

Article 9: Appendices

Appendix A: Escalation Contact Matrix

Name	Title	Phone	Email	Availability
Contact 1	Manager L1	555-0101	mgr1@nova.co	24/7/365
Contact 2	Manager L2	555-0102	mgr2@nova.co	24/7/365
Contact 3	Manager L3	555-0103	mgr3@nova.co	24/7/365
Contact 4	Manager L4	555-0104	mgr4@nova.co	24/7/365
Contact 5	Manager L5	555-0105	mgr5@nova.co	24/7/365
Contact 6	Manager L6	555-0106	mgr6@nova.co	24/7/365
Contact 7	Manager L7	555-0107	mgr7@nova.co	24/7/365
Contact 8	Manager L8	555-0108	mgr8@nova.co	24/7/365

Appendix B: Approved maintenance tools and access methods

VPN, bastion hosts, SSH keys, SIEM agents.

Appendix C: Compliance Control Mapping

CTL-001 (SOC 2 CC6.1) - Logical Access Controls: Multi-factor authentication enforced for all administrative access to customer environments. Hardware security keys required for privileged operations.

CTL-002 (SOC 2 CC6.2) - Network Security: Microsegmentation deployed between customer tenants using VXLAN overlays with distributed firewall enforcement at the hypervisor level.

CTL-003 (ISO 27001 A.9.2) - User Provisioning: Automated identity lifecycle management with just-in-time privilege elevation and 90-day access recertification cycles.

CTL-004 (PCI-DSS 3.4) - Data Encryption at Rest: AES-256-GCM encryption for all customer volumes using per-tenant encryption keys stored in FIPS 140-2 Level 3 HSM appliances.

CTL-005 (PCI-DSS 4.1) - Data Encryption in Transit: TLS 1.3 enforced for all external-facing services. IPsec tunnels with AES-256-CBC for inter-datacenter replication traffic.

CTL-006 (ISO 27001 A.12.4) - Audit Logging: Centralized SIEM ingestion of all authentication, authorization, and configuration change events. 13-month retention with tamper-evident storage.

CTL-007 (SOC 2 CC7.2) - Incident Response: Documented incident response playbooks for 14 scenario types, tested quarterly through tabletop exercises with customer participation.

CTL-008 (HIPAA 164.312(a)) - Unique User Identification: Individual user accounts for all personnel accessing customer environments. Shared accounts prohibited by policy.

CTL-009 (PCI-DSS 6.6) - Web Application Firewall: Layer 7 WAF deployed for all customer-facing web applications with OWASP Top 10 rule sets updated monthly.

CTL-010 (ISO 27001 A.11.1) - Physical Security Perimeter: 24/7 security staffing, biometric access control, mantrap entry, CCTV with 90-day footage retention.

CTL-011 (SOC 2 CC8.1) - Change Management: All infrastructure changes tracked in ServiceNow with CAB approval workflow. Emergency changes require post-implementation review within 48 hours.

CTL-012 (HIPAA 164.308(a)(7)) - Contingency Planning: Annual business impact analysis, disaster recovery plans tested semi-annually, and emergency mode operation procedures documented.

CTL-013 (PCI-DSS 10.2) - System Activity Monitoring: Real-time alerting on privilege escalation, failed authentication attempts exceeding threshold, and configuration changes to security controls.

CTL-014 (ISO 27001 A.14.2) - Secure Development: SDLC policy requiring static analysis, dependency scanning, and penetration testing before production deployment of platform updates.

CTL-015 (SOC 2 CC3.2) - Risk Assessment: Annual enterprise risk assessment using NIST 800-30 methodology with quarterly updates for emerging threats.

CTL-016 (PCI-DSS 11.3) - Penetration Testing: Semi-annual external penetration testing by qualified third-party assessor. Internal vulnerability scanning conducted weekly.

CTL-017 (ISO 27001 A.15.1) - Supplier Management: Annual security assessments of critical subcontractors including power utilities, fiber providers, and hardware vendors.

CTL-018 (HIPAA 164.312(c)) - Data Integrity Controls: Checksumming for data at rest and in transit. Automated integrity verification during backup and replication operations.

CTL-019 (SOC 2 CC6.7) - Data Disposal: NIST 800-88 certified media sanitization. Certificate of destruction provided within 30 days of contract termination.

CTL-020 (PCI-DSS 12.8) - Service Provider Compliance: Annual PCI DSS compliance validation for all third-party service providers processing, storing, or transmitting cardholder data.

Appendix D: Network Service Specifications

NS-01 - Dedicated Bandwidth: Minimum guaranteed bandwidth per customer environment: 1 Gbps for CS-100 through CS-400 tiers, 10 Gbps for CS-800 through CS-3200 tiers, 25 Gbps for CS-6400 and CS-GPU tiers.

NS-02 - Intra-Region Latency: Maximum round-trip latency between any two NovaBridge compute instances within the same availability zone: 0.25 milliseconds. Cross-zone latency within the same region: 1.0 milliseconds.

NS-03 - Internet Transit: Blended Tier 1 transit from Cogent, Lumen, and GTT with minimum aggregate capacity of 400 Gbps. Route optimization via Noction IRP for latency-sensitive workloads.

NS-04 - DDoS Mitigation: Always-on volumetric DDoS protection up to 2 Tbps scrubbing capacity. Application-layer protection with sub-10-second detection and automatic mitigation.

NS-05 - DNS Services: Managed authoritative DNS with 100 percent SLA. Anycast resolution from 28 global points of presence. DNSSEC signing supported.

NS-06 - Load Balancing: Layer 4 and Layer 7 load balancing with SSL offloading, session persistence, health checking, and WebSocket support.

NS-07 - VPN Connectivity: Site-to-site IPsec VPN with IKEv2, supporting up to 10 concurrent tunnels per customer environment. Maximum throughput per tunnel: 2 Gbps.

NS-08 - Cross-Connect: Physical cross-connect options: single-mode fiber (1G/10G/100G), copper (1G). Monthly charges: \$300 per 1G, \$500 per 10G, \$1,500 per 100G.

NS-09 - Packet Loss: Maximum packet loss target: 0.01 percent measured monthly across the NovaBridge backbone network.

NS-10 - Jitter: Maximum jitter target: 1.0 milliseconds measured at the 99th percentile over a calendar month.

Appendix E: Detailed Pricing and Fee Schedules

The following tables detail all recurring and non-recurring charges applicable under this Agreement. All prices are in United States Dollars and are exclusive of applicable taxes.

E.1 Managed Services Add-On Pricing

Service	Description	Monthly Rate
OS Patching	Monthly OS patch cycle with pre-patch snapshot and rollback capability	\$45/instance
Database Administration	Oracle/SQL Server DBA support including performance tuning, backup, HA config	\$850/instance
24/7 Monitoring	Infrastructure monitoring with 15-min polling, automated alerting, NOC escalation	\$120/instance
Log Management	Centralized log aggregation, 90-day hot retention, 13-month archive	\$0.50/GB ingested
Vulnerability Scanning	Weekly automated scans with remediation reporting and SLA-based patching	\$75/instance
SSL Certificate Mgmt	Procurement, installation, renewal, and monitoring of TLS certificates	\$25/certificate
Firewall Rule Mgmt	Change request processing for firewall rule additions, modifications, and audits	\$200/month + \$15/change
Dedicated vCISO	Virtual CISO providing quarterly strategy review and compliance oversight	\$3,500/month

E.2 Non-Recurring Charges

Item	Description	One-Time Fee
Environment Provisioning	Initial setup of VPC, network segments, security groups, monitoring agents	\$2,500/environment
Data Migration Assist	Engineering support for workload migration: sizing, testing, cutover coordination	\$175/hour
Custom Integration	API development, SSO integration, custom monitoring dashboards	\$200/hour
Cross-Connect Install	Physical fiber or copper cross-connect to carrier or IX in same facility	\$500 - \$2,000
Hardware Decommission	NIST 800-88 certified data destruction with certificate of destruction	\$50/drive
Emergency Onsite	After-hours remote-hands escalation beyond included allocation	\$250/hour (4hr min)

Appendix F: Operational Procedures Summary

F.1 Onboarding Process

The customer onboarding process follows a structured six-phase methodology: (1) Kickoff and requirements gathering within the first five business days of contract execution; (2) Environment design review including network topology, security zone architecture, and storage tier allocation; (3) Infrastructure provisioning targeting completion within fifteen business days of design approval; (4) Connectivity validation encompassing VPN tunnel establishment, cross-connect activation, and bandwidth verification; (5) Workload migration executed in agreed-upon waves with rollback checkpoints; and (6) Operational handoff including monitoring dashboard configuration, runbook delivery, and escalation path confirmation.

F.2 Scheduled Maintenance Procedures

NovaBridge conducts scheduled maintenance during the approved window of Tuesdays 02:00 to 06:00 Eastern Time, with a maximum of four hours per month. Maintenance notifications are delivered via email to designated customer contacts a minimum of five business days in advance for standard maintenance and twenty-four hours for urgent security patches. Each maintenance window includes a pre-maintenance health check, the maintenance activity itself, and a post-maintenance validation phase.

F.3 Capacity Management

NovaBridge maintains a minimum of twenty percent headroom across all shared infrastructure tiers (compute, storage, network) to accommodate customer growth and burst requirements. Monthly capacity reports are delivered as part of the standard reporting package, including trailing six-month utilization trends and ninety-day forward projections. When any resource dimension reaches seventy-five percent sustained utilization over a fourteen-day period, the capacity management team initiates a proactive expansion workflow.

F.4 Incident Communication Protocols

During a service-affecting incident, NovaBridge follows a structured communication cadence: initial notification within the response time defined by incident severity (15 minutes for Severity 1, 30 minutes for Severity 2), followed by status updates every thirty minutes for Severity 1, every sixty minutes for Severity 2, and every four hours for Severity 3. A preliminary root cause analysis is delivered within five business days of incident resolution, and a final post-incident report within fifteen business days.

Exhibit A.1: Service Credit Schedule

NovaBridge's stepped service credit schedule based on monthly availability measurement. Credits are calculated as a percentage of the monthly recurring charge for affected services and applied to the following month's invoice.

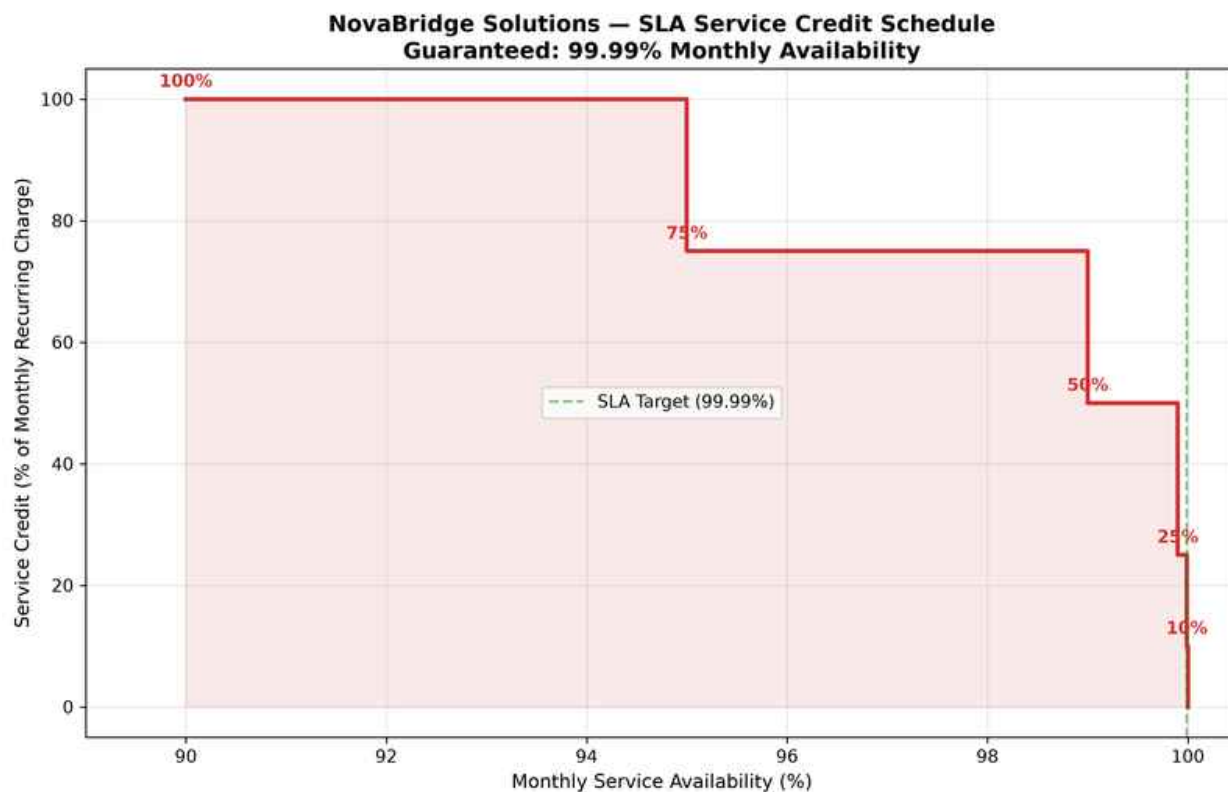


Exhibit A.2: Compute Tier Pricing

Monthly pricing for each of NovaBridge's five compute tiers, ranging from standard general-purpose instances to GPU-accelerated configurations for compute-intensive workloads.

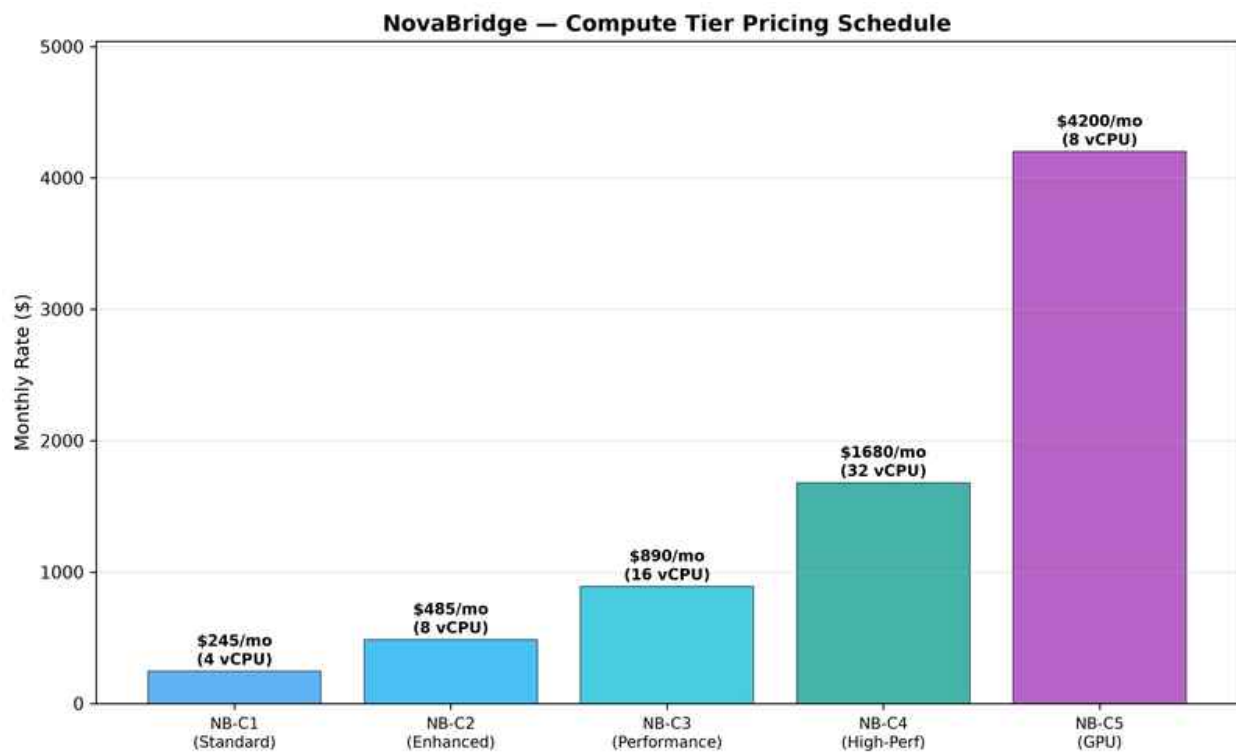


Exhibit A.3: Disaster Recovery RPO/RTO

Recovery Point Objective and Recovery Time Objective targets for each disaster recovery tier. Mission-Critical tier provides near-synchronous replication with 1-minute RPO and 5-minute RTO.

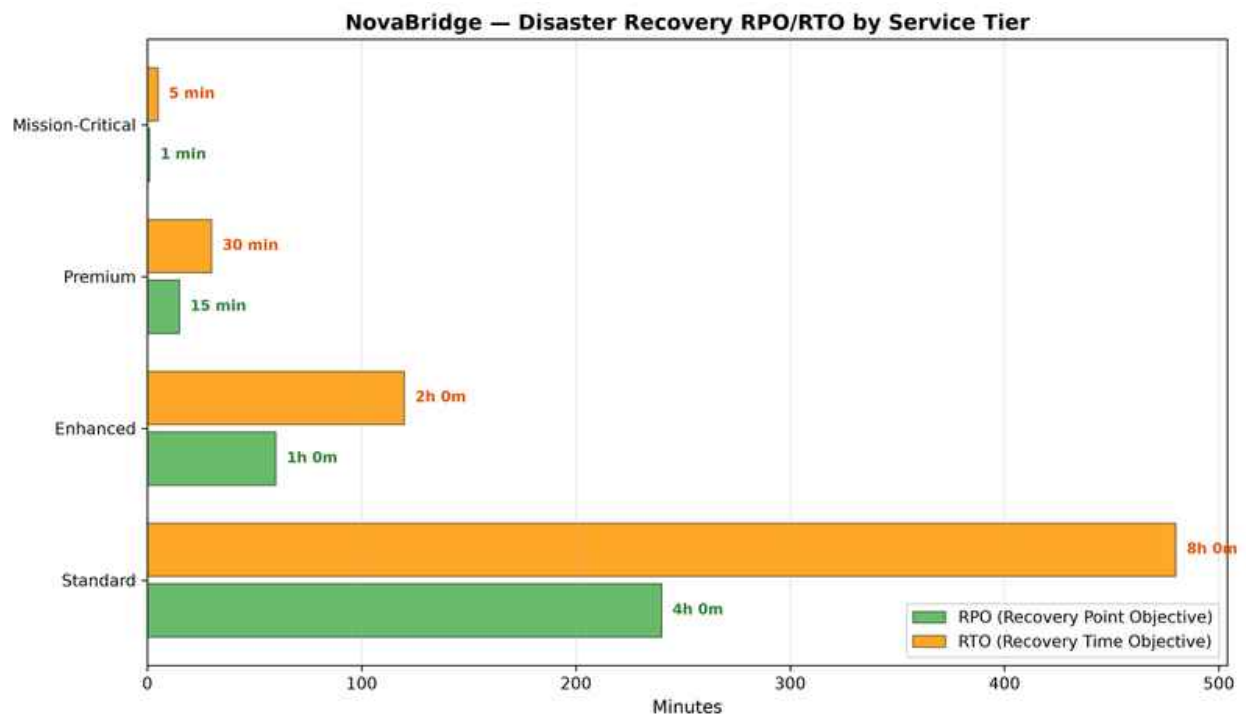


Exhibit A.4: Incident Response Targets

Response and resolution time targets by incident severity level. Severity 1 incidents trigger 15-minute response and 60-minute resolution targets with automatic escalation to the VP of Operations.

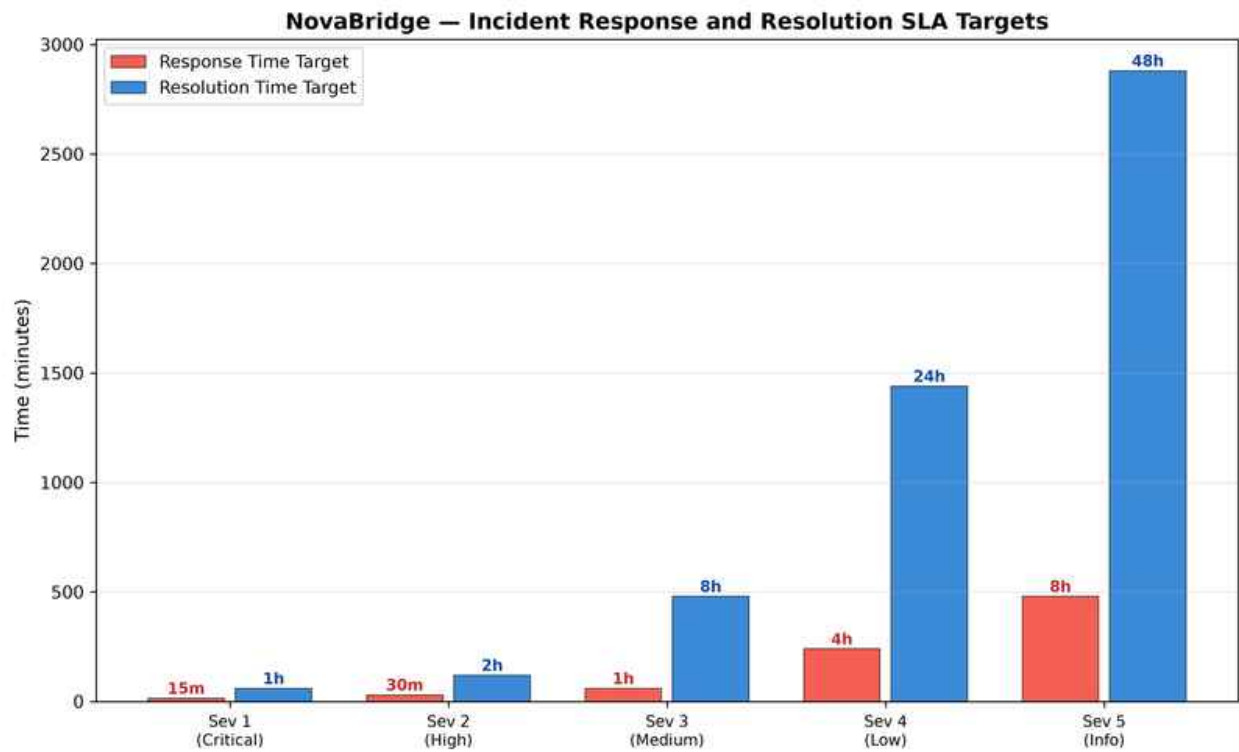


Exhibit A.5: Storage Tier Pricing

Per-GB monthly pricing for each storage tier with corresponding IOPS limits. NVMe Flash tier offers the highest performance at \$0.120/GB with 10,000 IOPS per volume.

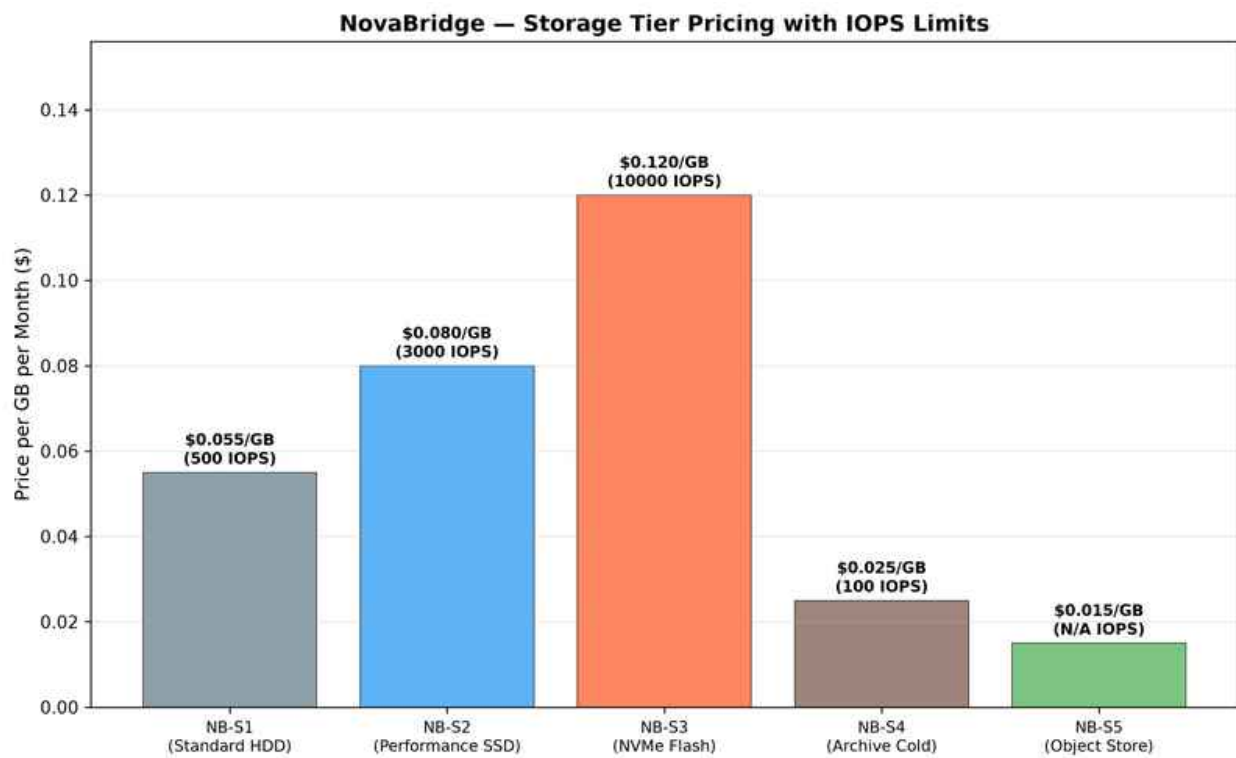


Exhibit A.6: Service Capability Assessment

Radar chart showing NovaBridge's self-assessed capability scores across six key service dimensions, validated against their most recent SOC 2 Type II report and customer reference checks.

